



"They can smell sponsored from a mile away"

SOHA ALI KHAN ON THE MID-40S SHIFT THAT STARTED HER PODCASTING JOURNEY AND BOOTSTRAPPING THE FIRST 30 EPISODES

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Soha Ali Khan did not come to podcasting as a choreographed strategy. She found it while dealing with her own 40s, from a run of expensive appointments with nutritionists, gynaecologists and hormone experts whose advice sometimes contradicted itself. That's how *All About Her* was born. Now a year old and shooting an episode a week, she built around conversations of women's health and wellness she was having herself in real-life.

She recorded 30 episodes with her own money before deciding to partner with brands. For anyone weighing up a podcast of their own, her answers are a useful counterweight to the scale-and-systems approach. She's a beacon for building slowly, over-preparing, and refusing the clickbait headline.

Everyone knows you from Bollywood. What was the impetus behind jumping into podcasting?

Soha: The impetus was, I do enjoy the world of nonfiction. I've always been a reader. And in my 40s, especially when I hit 45, is when I started feeling a shift in myself, mentally, physically, emotionally. So I felt myself having lots of conversations around wellness – for the first time I was speaking to a nutritionist, a therapist, gynaecologists, hormone experts. All of those conversations cost a certain amount of money. Things that they were asking me to do also cost a certain amount of money. Some of them would contradict each other. And I said, I have access, I have money, I'm having these conversations. Wouldn't it be nice to take these conversations public and share them with an audience that would benefit from it.